



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

April 2017

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for May is

April 21

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to:

office@minnehaha.org

3701 East 50th Street

Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

April



SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:00 am Education and Fellowship

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in April

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
						1 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
2 Communion 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Ed. & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 7p SAA 7p Venturing Crew	3 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Finance	4 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	5 10a Staff Meeting 1p Mi'haha circle 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Dinner 6:15p Children 6:15p Prayer Pract. 6:15p Youth Meeting 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	6 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	7 <i>World Health Day</i> 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p NAMI (additional) 6:30p RCA	8 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
9 <i>Palm Sunday</i> 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Ed. & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth Council 6p Youth Night (grades 6-12) 6p Living Brave 6:30p Togo Church 7p Pack 1 Plan. 7p SAA	10 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts	11 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6p Nokomis Prov.	12 9:30a Nokomis Circle 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Dinner 6p Mandala 6:15p Children 6:45p Chancel Choir	13 <i>Maundy Thursday</i> 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 7p Maundy Thursday Service	14 <i>Good Friday</i> Good Friday 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA 6p Youth Rehearsal 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Good Friday Taizé Service	15
16 <i>Easter</i> 7a Sunrise 8a Breakfast 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Egg Hunt etc 11a Worship with Band 7p SAA 7p Venturing Crew	17 <i>Tax Day (Taxes Due)</i> 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Women's Soul Group 6:30p Road/Walking	18 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council 6:30p Toastmasters	19 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Dinner 6:15p Children 6:45p Chancel Choir	20 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Gospel of John 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	21 <i><u>Newsletter items due</u></i> 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	22 <i>Earth Day</i> 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
23 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Ed. & Fellowship 10:15a 5th gr intro 11a Worship w/Band 6p Youth & Conf.Classes 6p Living Brave 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	24 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p Road/Walking	25 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	26 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Dinner 6:15p Children 6:45p Chancel Choir	27 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Gospel of John 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	28 <i>Arbor Day</i> 9a Brighter Minds 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	29 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
30 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Ed. & Fellowship 10:15 7th gr intro 11a Worship w/Band 6p Living Brave 6p Youth & Conf. Classes 7p SAA	Notes:					

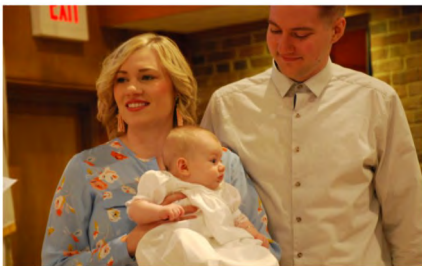
Worship in April

We will conclude our series on prayer with the end of Lent, halfway through April this year. Holy week is the week of April 10, with a Maundy Thursday service at 7:00 on April 13 and Good Friday on April 14. See articles elsewhere for more details. Easter Sunday is April 16, with our sunrise service at 7:00 in addition to our regular services at 9:00 and 11:00. Easter isn't a one-time event, though, so we'll hear the stories of people who Jesus continued to appear to throughout the month of April, with the story of Thomas on April 23 and the two walking to Emmaus on April 30. We'll see you in worship!

2nd	"Prayers of Thanksgiving" <i>Communion</i>	Psalm 150
9th	"Praying Though Action" <i>6th Sunday of Lent</i>	Matthew 21:1-11
13th	Maundy Thursday Service 7:00 pm	
14th	Good Friday Tenebrae Taizé 7:00 pm	
16th	Easter "An Answer to Prayer" <i>Sunrise service 7:00, Worship with Organ & Choir 9:00, Worship with Band 11:00</i>	John 20:1-18
23rd	"Two Sides of the Same Coin"	John 20:19-31
30th	"Stranger on the Road"	Luke 24:13-35

Future Special Events at Minnehaha UMC—Save the Date

May 21 – One worship service at 10:00 – Children's Musical
 May 22 – 2:00 Trip to see SweetLand at the History Theatre
 May 28 – One worship service at 10:00 – Memorial Day weekend
 June 4 – One worship service at 10:00 – Blessing of bike helmets and picnic outside following the service
 June 11 – One worship service at 10:00 – Graduation Sunday
 June 18 – Outdoor 10:30 worship begins
 June 20-22 – Annual Conference in St. Cloud
 June 19-23 – Music and Drama Camp
 June 21-23 – Vacation Bible School
 July 16-18 – Minnehaha Adventure Camp for youth going into grades 6-7 at Koinonia Retreat Center
 July 23-28 – Minnehaha Wilderness Camp for youth going into grades 8-12 (plus recent graduates) at Star Lake Wilderness Camp



Quinn Colter Sikorski was baptized March 12



Holy Week at Minnehaha

Palm Sunday - April 9th

Worship at 9 and 11am - Children are invited to join in the Palm Processional, and the Cherub Choir will be singing at both services

Maundy Thursday - April 13th

Worship with Communion at 7pm

Good Friday - April 14th

The sanctuary will be opened for contemplation and Stations of the Cross from 9am-5pm

Tenebrae/Taizé Worship at 7pm

Easter Sunday - April 16th

Sunrise Service at 7am; Breakfast served from 8-9am; Worship with organ, choir, Hallelujah Chorus & Children's Choir at 9am; Breakfast, Easter Egg Hunt & Easter Crafts from 10-11am; Worship with band & Children's Choir at 11am

Youth Ministries

**Here is a look forward at the next month for our Youth program. We have a lot of activities coming up for our Youth and volunteers with opportunities to Seek, Serve, and to Celebrate!
All the things we do best here at Minnehaha.**

April 2nd – No Confirmation Classes: Spring Break

April 5th – No Sunrise Service planning: Many youth and parents have said that Wednesday nights will not work, so we have canceled our Wednesday evenings and will continue to work on the Easter Sunrise service during Sunday school. Thank you for your feedback!

April 9th – Youth Night: Goes from **5:00-8:00pm**. Back by popular demand - Youth are going to play Laser Tag! The cost is \$10.00 per youth. Please RSVP so we have proper transportation. ***Friends are always welcome to join us! And we can still use a extra chaperone or two!***

April 15th – Final Sunrise Service Rehearsal: From 5:00-6:30 in the Sanctuary. Youth will be setting up props and running through their Easter Sunrise Service project. If your youth will be participating in this year's Easter Sunrise service, please make sure they make it to this rehearsal. Thank you!

April 16th – Easter Sunday: Youth run Sunrise service at 7:00am - Please have all youth to MUMC by 6:30 to get ready, Breakfast is being served in the basement at 8am, During the Traditional service at 9am the youth will be hiding the Easter eggs for the Children's egg hunt, Sunday school festivities including the egg hunt start at 10am, and the Contemporary Worship service is at 11am.

****We are currently working and planning the Easter Sunrise Service, If your youth would like to be part of it but has yet to come to a planning night we still have plenty of spots where they could jump in! Let me know as soon as possible and we can get them involved! Also.. If you know for sure that your youth WILL NOT be able to make it to the Sunrise service please let us know. There are still lots of ways they can participate in planning and practicing even though they can't make it. Thank you!****

April 16th – No Confirmation Classes: Easter Sunday

April 23rd – Confirmation Night: Goes from 6:00-7:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the Youth room and the older class will be meeting in the Wesley Room, both classes will be discussing Free Will.

April 30th- Youth are giving Bibles to 2nd Graders during both services

– Confirmation Night: Goes from 6:00-7:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be meeting in the Wesley Room and will be discussing the Sacraments: Baptism.

May 2nd – Enchilada rolling night: Youth and Parents are encouraged to meet in the kitchen from 6-7pm to help roll enchiladas for the Youth fundraiser the following night.

May 3rd – Enchilada Dinner fundraiser night: Youth are serving Enchiladas from 5:30-7:00 in the kitchen to help raise money for the youth program. Please bring the family and invite everyone you know to come and eat Rick Anderson's delicious enchiladas and help support our amazing program!

In case Camps are not on your calendar yet here are the dates, and please contact Leilani if you have any other questions!

-Minnehaha Adventure Camp: July 16-18 (finished grades 5th & 6th this spring) at Koinonia Retreat Center

-Minnehaha Wilderness Camp: July 23-28 (finished grades 7th-12th this spring) at Star Lake Campgrounds

Leilani Thompson, Director of Youth Ministries

Children's Ministries

Throughout Lent, we've been focusing on prayer. Why do we pray? How do we pray? Hopefully, you've taken a moment or two to explore prayer as a family. If not, Lent's not over yet! We encourage you to take time to talk as a family, to stop by our prayer station, to consider what it means to set aside time in our lives to intentionally pause and connect with God. Whether it is through grace at mealtime, bedtime prayers, coloring prayers, praying with a map or newspaper, prayer beads or labyrinths: creating space - individually or as a family - for prayer helps ground us. We hope you continue exploring prayer far beyond Lent.

During Holy Week, there are some special opportunities for you to worship at Minnehaha. Holy Week is the most sacred time of church year, taking time to participate in the lead up to Easter helps make the miracle of the resurrection more meaningful for people of all ages. And, yes, at different points in our lives we'll be able to deal with the various aspects of Holy Week in different ways. But, people of all ages (the youngest of children!) are invited along in this journey - and participation in the rituals and worship at young ages help connect them to their community and lead them down a lifetime of exploring the mysteries of faith.

On Palm Sunday: We celebrate Jesus' entrance into Jerusalem. He arrives knowing what awaits him there. But, this day is one of celebration, the crowds cheer, and Jesus says if they were silenced, even the rocks would cry out!

To mark this day, children are invited to process in with palm branches and our cherub (preschool and kindergarten) choir will sing at both services.

On Maundy Thursday: We remember the Last Supper - Jesus gathering with his disciples to share in the Passover Meal. The words we hear each time we celebrate communion are based in this event. We remember what it is to be in community with each other, to serve one another and love God.

To mark this day, we have a worship service at 7pm. This service will be a communion service.

On Good Friday: We remember Jesus' trial and crucifixion. We remember how his followers struggled to figure out what to do - and Peter denying Jesus' three times. We remember how the Roman authorities struggled to figure out what to do - finding Jesus not guilty but having to respond to the demands of the Jewish authorities. We are reminded that we are not alone when we struggle in determining how to love one another.

To mark this day, throughout the day we will have Stations of the Cross paintings by Ettore DeGrazia displayed in the sanctuary. Come alone or as a family to look at these images and reflect on the events of Holy Week - this is another way to explore prayer. **Then, at 7pm, we will have our monthly Taizé service, with a Tenebrae style.** For a Tenebrae Service, candles are gradually distinguished as the scripture is read, leading us into darkness. This worship service is a time to quietly meditate and reflect on the death of Jesus.

On Easter: We celebrate Jesus' resurrection! We have three worship services, breakfast, and activities throughout the morning. **All children are invited to process into worship with flowers, and our Children's Choir (first through fifth grade) will sing at the 9 and 11 am services.**

Please let me know if you have any questions or concerns about Holy Week at Minnehaha, or with any aspect of Children's Ministries.

We look forward to celebrating Easter with you!
Happy Spring,
Jenia Strom, Director of Children & Family Ministries

Join us for

2017 Summer Programming at

Minnehaha UMC

Music and Drama Camp
June 19th-June 23rd
An all-day camp for children who have completed third through eighth grade. Campers will spend the week working on all aspects of a musical production, which will feature the songs and stories of Sandra Boynton.

Hero Central:
Discover Your Strength in God!
Vacation Bible School
June 21st-June 23rd
A morning program for children in preschool through fifth grade. An opportunity for kids to grow and learn through games, arts & crafts, music, and more. Extended afternoon daycare available.

Summer Camps
through Camp Minnesota
Overnight camps for elementary children. Join with other children from around the Minnesota Conference for summer camp. We'll hike, canoe, do arts and crafts, swim, have campfires, and learn about God and the world around us. A group will be attending Trailblazers 2 at Koronis (July 16-19) if you'd like to attend with other Minnehaha campers. Register soon to get your space!





Questions? Contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org/612.721.6231
Register at www.minnehaha.org for VBS & Music & Drama Camp and at www.campminnesota.org for overnight camps

Highlights from the March 14, 2017 Church Council Meeting

TREASURER'S REPORT: Treasurer Dennis Feller told us that the church's finances are where they should be right now. (That's a good thing.) Pledges are coming in on schedule, all bills have been paid, mortgage payments have been made (including prepayments!), and apportionments and interfund loan payments have been made through February 28, 2017. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

LAST ONE TO LEAVE THE CHURCH? If you're at church in the evening, check with other groups to identify who will be the last to leave. If you are the last one out the door, be sure to turn off all the lights, lock the doors and set the alarm. Instructions are available on the church website (Building Use > Work Orders, Building & Kitchen > Building Use Guidelines) or talk to Kim Kanuit. Thank you! (Kim Kanuit, Trustees Chair)

HEALTHY CHURCH INITIATIVE (HCI) UPDATE: It's been nearly a year since the church passed the Healthy Church Initiative, which is our strategic plan to grow the church. What's been done? I'll list a few. Communicate the Vision (We Seek. We Serve. We Celebrate.) Offer spiritually-focused classes like Spirit Walk and Elie Wiesel's "Night." Create new MUMC t-shirts and onesies. A year-long book reading as a congregation: "We Make the Road by Walking." New responsive website: www.minnehaha.org. Conduct leadership training for 35 leaders. Have quarterly staff meeting get-togethers. Promote forums on key issues, such as immigration. Champion the all-church work day on March 11. And bring coffee service to the Narthex. And that doesn't include all the great, strategically-significant things being done by Trustees; Children's, Youth & Adult Ministries; Welcoming; Staff-Parish Relations; Finance; Communications; Outreach; Caring Ministries; and Worship. (Dean Ammerman, HCI Chair)

ADOPT A ROOM AT MUMC: We want to keep the rooms picked-up and looking good all the time. So we're creating a list where you can sign up to "adopt" one of our wonderful rooms. Contact Valerie Mayer, Kim Kanuit or Dean Ammerman. (Valerie Mayer, Lay Delegate)

CHECK OUT OUR SUMMER EVENTS FOR KIDS AND YOUTH: There's still time to sign up for summer activities and camps. There's "Hero Central" Vacation Bible School, a morning program for children in preschool through fifth grade from June 21 – 23. Music & Drama Camp, an all-day camp for children who have completed third through eighth grade from June 19 – 23. Methodist summer camps like the Trailblazers 2 hike/canoe/arts/swim camp at Koronis from July 16 – 19. And more! Links for sign-up are on the website, or talk to Jenia. (Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries)

NENA "FOOD & FUN" EVENT: On May 20, from Noon to 3:00 PM, the Nokomis East Neighborhood Association (NENA) will have what they're calling a "Food & Fun" event for the 1,200+ rental units that make up the Bossen Apartments. (North of Crosstown, west of 34th.) The Council agreed to donate \$100 toward a bicycle for a giveaway. The church will also have a table so we can let folks know who we are and what we do in the neighborhood. (Becky Sechrist, Pastor)



**Join us at Minnehaha for
Wednesday Night Suppers!**

Throughout the winter and spring, join us for supper from 5:30-6:30 in the Fellowship Hall.

Cost for Dinner:
\$5 for those 4 years and older
Free for children under 4
Family Cap: \$20
**PURCHASE A PUNCH CARD &
RECEIVE FOUR MEALS FREE!**

Following dinner, there is programming for children from 6:15 to 7pm.

THREE CHURCHES MEET: Minnehaha United Methodist, St. James Episcopal and Lake Nokomis Lutheran churches continue to meet to discuss how we can all work together to make a stronger impact in the neighborhood. Maureen Trepp, Renee Beymer and Janice Linster are involved in the conversations. (Becky Sechrist, Pastor)

NEXT MEETING APRIL 18 AT 6:30 PM: The next Church Council meeting is scheduled for April 18 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request.

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

HCI One-year Check-up

Minnehaha UMC approved the Healthy Church Initiative (HCI) recommendations on May 15, 2016. Here are some of the things we've done as a result of those recommendations:

- Communicate our Vision (We Seek. We Serve. We Celebrate.)
- Spiritually-focused Sermons ("Spiritual Types" series)
- Spiritually-focused Classes (i.e., Spirit Walk, Elie Wiesel's *Night*)
- New MUMC T-shirts and Onesies
- Year-long Book Reading (*We Make the Road by Walking*)
- New Responsive Website (www.minnehaha.org)
- Leadership Training (35 leaders trained)
- More hours for Director of Children's Ministries
- Quarterly Staff Meeting Get-togethers
- Forums on Key Issues (i.e., immigration, Women's March)
- New Giving Envelope for Food Ministries
- All-church Work Day (Sat., March 11)
- Narthex Coffee Service



Auction Update

Thank you all for your support for the 35th Annual Auction - at Minnehaha on March 4th. We cleared over \$4500 - to go directly into the church budget. We are grateful for your support of MUMC so that it can continue the good work on the corner of 37th and 50th - the neighborhood and as far as we are able.

Eric, Barb, Alex and Brad Pederson



Sold! Thanks to everyone who came to the auction!



United Methodist Women

- Please join us on Sat., May 6 to celebrate the Greatest Generation: members and family of Minnehaha UMC who are over 90 years old! We will be having a birthday party during our annual salad luncheon that day. The event begins at 11:00 with lunch served after a brief program. If you would like to donate a salad, please sign up with Beth Minehart; the more variety the better!
- We will be serving at Simpson Shelter again on May 22nd; join us!
- Be sure to order your potted or hanging plants that you will be able to pick up on May 6 and 7.

Food Ministries

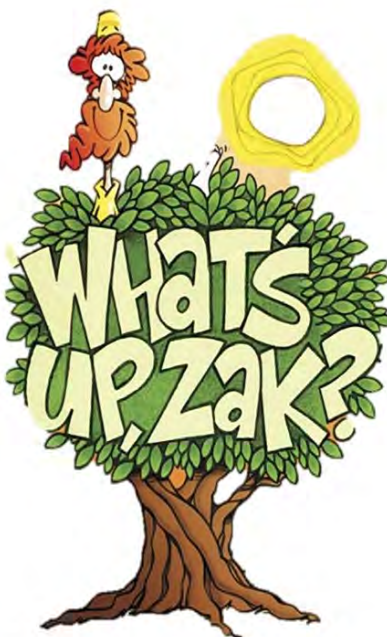
MUMC supports **two food ministries**. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, or you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the memo line.

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Sq.

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of the chapter we are reading for the week in *We Make The Road By Walking*. Anyone is welcome to come. This month we will be gathering on April 13.



Children sang for Camping Sunday



It's Time! Throughout this spring, children at Minnehaha are preparing for the 2017 Children's Musical: *What's Up Zak?*

Minnehaha First through Fifth Graders will work together throughout the winter and spring - learning the story of Zacchaeus - preparing all parts of the musical for Children's Sunday, May 21st.

Rehearsals: **Wednesday Nights, from 6:15-7pm**

All are encouraged to come Wednesday nights; in particular those with speaking lines and those interested in helping with sets, props, costumes, etc.

&

Sunday Mornings, during Music Time

All of our elementary students will be involved in this musical - those that can't make Wednesday Night rehearsals will be learning the townspeople songs during our Sunday morning music time.

Preschoolers and Kindergarteners will be featured in a couple of numbers as well, they will rehearse these as part of their Sunday morning time; on Wednesday evenings are invited to the Preschool Room for programming.

If you have any questions, please contact Jennifer Schroeder (jenniferfr@hotmail.com), Eric Strom (ericmostrom@gmail.com), or Jenia Strom (education@minnehaha.org)

Holy Week Services

Holy Week is observed during the last week of Lent, between Palm Sunday (April 9) and Easter Sunday (April 16). It is traditionally a time to remember Jesus' entry into Jerusalem, his last supper with the disciples, and his arrest, trial and death. We'll be offering a Maundy Thursday service in the sanctuary with communion at 7:00. We will also have a Good Friday service, which falls on the same date as our April Taizé Service. It will also start at 7:00 and will include 14 readings from the gospel of Matthew about the events leading up to Jesus' death, and there will be some singing of Taizé hymns as well as times of silence.

In addition, the sanctuary will be open on Good Friday between 9:00 and 5:00 for anyone who would like to engage in some silent contemplation. There is a centuries-old tradition of observing Stations of the Cross with words or artwork signifying important stops on Jesus' journey to the cross. Utilizing artwork by DeGrazia, we will have stations set up in the sanctuary.

Easter Services

Join us for Easter Sunday on April 16. We'll start out with a sunrise service at 7:00 a.m. in the sanctuary. The youth will be leading this worship, and have a great theme planned. The Men's Group will serve breakfast from 8-9 and again from 10-11, and there is an Easter egg hunt for children from 10-11. At 9:00 is a more traditional service with choir and organ (and the singing of the Hallelujah Chorus), and the 11:00 service features band and vocals. We hope to see you Easter morning!

New Spring Classes

Monday night and Thursday morning adult classes will start with new themes after Easter. John Darlington will lead the Thursday morning 10am – 11am class with a look at the Gospel of John and Becky Sechrist will lead the Monday evening 6:30pm – 7:30pm class as we continue to follow the chapters in *We Make This Road By Walking*.



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

Our Easter Garden

The Sanctuary will be decorated with flowering spring plants Easter morning. To contribute, please complete this form and bring/mail it to the church office or place it in an offering, with your payment, by March 31.

Given By: _____

Phone: _____

Suggested donation \$20. You may give more if you wish.

Given in:

☐ Memory of ☐ Celebration of ☐ Honor of ☐ _____
other

(please print)



(Plants may be taken home after the **11:00** Easter service or during the following week.)



Let there be light! Thanks to everyone who came to clean up day!

Join Us for a Birthday Party to Celebrate the Greatest Generation



An event hosted by the United Methodist Women.

Come all of you
born in 1927
or earlier with
your family and
friends, men
and women, for
festivities.

\$8 for Adults
\$4 for Children

Saturday, May 6 @ 11:00 a.m.

Memories • Salad • Cake

Minnehaha United Methodist Church • 3701 East 50th Street, Mpls. MN

Rick's Wild Rice Enchilada Dinner

This is a fund Raiser for Minnehaha Youth Programs

On: May 3, 2017

Serving Time: 5:00 pm to 7:00 pm

Cost: Adults - \$10.00

Kids 6 - 12 - \$5.00

Kids under 6 free

Family max - \$30.00



Menu -

Wild Rice & Chicken Enchiladas

Vegetarian Enchiladas

Spanish Rice

Black & Pinto Bean Ole

Chips & Salsa

Brownies

Four Vacuum Packs Enchiladas

Take home for \$ 10.00 per four pack



At

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 50th Street South

Minneapolis, MN 55417



Sunday, May 21, 2017 at 2:00 p.m.

Tickets: \$40.00*/ person

history theatre

30 East 10th Street, Saint Paul, MN 55101

1920. Inge Altenberg journeys to America to marry a bachelor farmer, sight unseen. But in the wake of WWI, Inge's German heritage turns her new neighbors against the match. Under cathedral skies, the determined young immigrant and her stoic farmer fight for their lives, facing their own misgivings and the harshness of an unforgiving land. A lyrical celebration of hard-won independence and a reflection of generations past, *Sweet Land* reminds us of who we are - and where we came from.

Join us before the performance for lunch at SAWATDEE - St. Paul, MN. There is a reservation for our group beginning at 12:00 noon. It is a short, 3 block walk to the History Theatre from the restaurant. Founder, Supeen Harrison was born near Bangkok, Thailand and opened the first Thai restaurant in the five state area in 1983.

*\$5.00 from each ticket sale will be contributed to Minnehaha United Methodist Church. Student tickets are available for \$25.00 each. Normal ticket prices are \$52 adults and \$50 senior.

Order Tickets by April 15, 2017

Contact: Becky Sechrist or
Sue Claude (612-834-4871)



Hardening Off

The hardest part of gardening for me is the hardening off. I start most of my plants from seed, inside a small greenhouse in my basement sometime in late January or early February. Some of the seeds don't germinate, sometimes a plant or two gets too dry and I have to reseed, but by the middle of April, I generally have a healthy crop of tomatoes, pansies, snap dragons, marigolds, basil, peppers, and a few other assorted plants. By then, they've outgrown my little greenhouse, and their flats are now all crowded on a table under a grow light meant for orchids that someone donated to me. This is the part where I get impatient. After nurturing them along for so many weeks, I just want to get them into the ground! But, first I have to wait until we are past danger of frost damage. Some of the plants are more sensitive to the cold than others, so some (like the pansies) can go in the ground early while others (like the impatiens) better wait until we aren't dropping below 40 at night. Still others are picky about the soil. If I put the peppers in the ground before the soil warms up sufficiently, they just sit there, refusing to grow until it gets nice and warm. And before each of these plants goes into the ground, they have to be hardened off. They've been raised in a protected environment – no wind, no sun. Just my temperature controlled house and some lamps. If I just stick them into the ground and walk away, they will die (trust me, I've done this). So, they have to be acclimated to the outdoors. The first day, I carry the flats outside into the sun and leave them there only an hour. Then, back to the basement they go. The next day, they get 2 hours outside, then 4, then 6, then 8, and then they can probably tolerate an entire day outside. If any of those days are completely overcast, then I have to wait another day. If it's pouring rain, I don't risk their fragile stems yet. As you can see, this process takes some time. It's the time involved in carrying them in and out as well as remembering that they have to come in (and, being home to get them back inside). It involves some careful timing. If I rush the project, or forget to bring them in, I can lose all those months of planting, germinating, and growing the plants in just a few hours.

This is not unlike my spiritual life, it turns out. Some practices have to be nurtured. I can't just take 6 weeks of a new Lenten practice, stick it in the ground of Easter and trust that the plant thrives. Sometimes that works, but more often than not, a spiritual practice needs more time nurturing, and more time acclimating to the environment. Honestly, sometimes it takes the entire period of Lent just to remind myself that I'm trying a new spiritual practice. This year, one of my Lenten practices is to not speed. I'm already into the 2nd week of Lent as I write this, and I am finding myself halfway to events (or church) before I remember that I'm trying to go the speed limit this Lent. Maybe by the time you read this my success rate will be up to one day a week.

Lent is a good time to try some practices out – I may not want to plant all of them. But the ones I do want to continue, I'll need to nurture. I'll need to acclimate them, get used to them, and then see what happens as they grow. If I forget, or try plant too soon, I'll just have to start again. Thankfully, God gives us an endless supply of seeds.

In joy,
Becky





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3/17



Easter Morning at Minnehaha UMC

7am: Sunrise Service led by the Minnehaha Youth

8-9am & 10-11am: Easter Breakfast served by the
Minnehaha Men's Group

9am: Worship with the Adult Choir, Children's Choir,
& join the Hallelujah Chorus

10am-11am: Easter Egg Hunt, Flower Making &
Easter Crafts

11am: Worship with the Band & Children's Choir

Celebrate the promise,
hope, and joy of Easter with us:
"He is not here, He is risen!" Luke 24:5

